



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Jackson Hole Classical Academy
School Website: <https://jhclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Jackson Hole Classical Academy (JHCA) presents a robust CLASSICAL education profile across the six classical criteria. Public materials consistently foreground a classical framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a Christian/theological orientation, serious engagement with virtue formation, and a pedagogy that balances contemplative elements with Socratic inquiry in upper grades. Evidence demonstrates explicit alignment with the core elements of classical education: the Trivium in curriculum and pedagogy, a Great-Books–leaning orientation through “the great works,” a vision of formation (virtue, wisdom, and love of truth, goodness, and beauty), dedicated teacher leadership, and an emphasis on parent involvement as partners in formation. The school frequently frames its mission using terms common to classical education, including truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; the Great Conversation; formation over mere information; and reverence for Western civilizational heritage. These patterns appear in the site’s Philosophy of Education, Curriculum descriptions, Upper/Lower School program pages, and statements about faculty and community life. Overall, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

- In Category 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations), JHCA clearly anchors education in a Christian framework (Nicene Creed, Jesus Christ-centered, and a belief in a Creator ordering reality). This is reinforced by explicit language about forming students toward virtue in a Christian context. Positive keyword signals (truth/goodness/beauty; creed; theology; liturgy/worship; wonder) are evident on the site and in program descriptions. The presence of a creedal framework and Christ-centered pedagogy aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for this category, with minimal to no negative signals observed in the public materials studied. CLASSICAL.
- In Element 2 (Purpose & Goal), the school repeatedly emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, a teleology grounded in truth, goodness, and beauty, and a liberal-arts-oriented aims rather than mere job-prep. The Philosophy of Education content frames life as a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, and the program positions education as formation rather than information, consistent with classical telos. Positive keyword indicators (formation; virtue; wisdom; liberal education; pursuit of true/good/beautiful) are present, with negligible negative signals in the public materials. CLASSICAL.
- In Element 3 (Curriculum), the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is front and center in multiple pages; the lower/upper school curricular structure explicitly follows grammar–logic–rhetoric progression; learning is tied to memorization and chant in early grades and to close reading and Great-Books-style study in upper grades. The site also emphasizes the Great Works and the Great Conversation (embedded in curriculum descriptions and references to “great works” and “the Trivium”). Positive keyword indicators (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation; memorization and chant; liberal arts) are evident. Negative indicators (e.g., a replacement of history with social studies, or a sole focus on project-based learning) are not evident in the public materials; if anything, the presence of the Great Books/Great Conversation motif reinforces the classical content frame. CLASSICAL.
- In Element 4 (Pedagogy/Teaching Methods), the site presents a bimodal pedagogy: contemplative/restful elements (Scholé-like memory work and reverence for wonder in the grammar stage) and high-structure Socratic/ Dialectic discourse in upper grades (Socratic seminars, debates, rhetoric, and public speaking). Evidence for Socratic discussion in upper school and rhetoric training is explicit;

lower school emphasizes memorization and wonder, including chant. Positive keyword indicators (Socratic dialogue/seminar; memorization; chanting; rhetoric; seminars) are robust; negative signals (overemphasis on experiential learning or project-based-only approaches) do not appear in the public materials. CLASSICAL.

- In Element 5 (Faculty), the public materials foreground model teachers and mentors; statements about Head of School leadership, living curriculum, and the faculty as the core of the school align with classical expectations for the living curriculum and virtuous mentorship. Positive keywords (model teachers; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture) are supported by multiple pages, including leadership profiles and faculty-focused content. Negative signals (overly “facilitator/guide on the side” language or credential-only jargon without classical context) are not evident in the materials reviewed. CLASSICAL.
- In Element 6 (Parents & Community), JHCA explicitly positions parents as partners and co-teachers and describes a Parent Partnership, parent formation activities, and broad opportunities for parent involvement (open visits, book groups, galleries, events). Positive keywords (partnership with families; parent formation; home-life/the home as a place of education; parent involvement) are present; negative signals (consumerism; minimal parent involvement) are not observed in the public content. CLASSICAL.

Overall Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL.

- If you’d like, I can extract precise sentence-level evidence for each category and provide a more granular, line-item appendix of quotes mapped to the six elements.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - JHCA presents a Christian frame of reference for education and the faculty alignment with the Nicene Creed; the Head of School and faculty profiles emphasize Christian formation and virtue formation. See Philosophy of Education and leadership/faculty materials. Evidence includes the creedal language and explicit Christian framing.
 - Public materials describe education as oriented by a Creator and a life of virtue, with truth, beauty, and goodness as real, knowable ideals. The public-facing narrative emphasizes the true/good/beautiful triad and the formation toward virtue in a Christian context.
 - The site consistently references the “true, good, and beautiful” as a central educational aim, including in outdoor/classroom contexts.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; creed/nicene creed; theology; worship/creed language; wonder; liturgical reverence (where explicit); God/Creator framing.
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials.
 - Frequency: 6+ positive keywords identified; 0 negative signals observed in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The school explicitly grounds education in a Christian metaphysical frame, invokes the Creed, and centers on truth/goodness/beauty as transcendent ideals. CLASSICAL.
- Citations and textual anchors
 - Christian framing and creed alignment: “private school in the classical and Christian traditions; believes that a Creator has ordered the world” and Creed language.
 - Creed explicit reference: Nicene Creed in leadership material.
 - Truth/Goodness/Beauty framing in curriculum: “the common love of the true, the good, and the beautiful.”

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Philosophy of Education ties formation of virtue and wisdom to a classical purpose; life aims at truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information.

- The site describes education as formation, not vocational job-training, and ties that formation to liberal-arts and classical aims (the Trivium framing).
- Great books/Great Conversation and the telos of classical education are embedded in the broader classical framing, with language around pursuit of universal truths through rigorous study and moral formation.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; liberal education; telos (implicit through classical mission); contemplation/scholé; Great Conversation; moral imagination.
 - Negative keywords present: minimal to none; the site does not push a workforce-prep or job-readiness framing as the sole objective.
 - Frequency: 4–6 clearly positive indicators in public materials; 0–1 latent negative signals.
 - Why this rating: The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and classical telos; education is oriented toward human flourishing and wisdom rather than solely job preparation. CLASSICAL.
- Citations and textual anchors
 - Formation/virtue/wisdom emphasis: “formation, cultivate virtue, human flourishing, wisdom” and related phrases.
 - Liberal-arts framing and Great Conversation references appear in curriculum descriptions and the “Philosophy of Education.”

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The core curriculum explicitly follows the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and emphasizes the liberal-arts structure. Public materials state: “The curriculum follows the classical paradigm of grammar, logic, and rhetoric,” and they map the grammar/logic/rhetoric stages to elementary/middle/high school.
 - Lower/Upper School sections describe grammar-stage memorization, chant, and memory work in early years; upper-school close reading, Socratic discussion, and essay writing; and Latin language study.
 - The site speaks to Great Books/Western canon through phrasing about “the great works” shaping history and forming judgment; a Great-Books–leaning program is implied in several program narratives.
 - “Incorporating The Outdoors” and other cross-curricular engagements show an integrated classical approach to curriculum content and wonder.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric); Great Books/Great Conversation; memorization/chanting; Latin/Greek; Western civilization; education as formation.
 - Negative keywords present: minimal to none; no evidence of a “social-studies-first” or non-historical framing in public content.
 - Frequency: 6–8 strong positive indicators; 0 observed negatives.
 - Why this rating: The explicit, repeated framing around Trivium-based curriculum and Great-Books–style engagement supports a CLASSICAL rating in Curriculum. CLASSICAL.
- Citations and textual anchors
 - Trivium/curriculum framing: “grammar, logic, and rhetoric” and “grammar stage/memory/chanting” throughout lower grades.
 - Upper School Socratic close reading and essay work; Latin as a foundational element.
 - Great works/Western canon phrasing: “the great works that have shaped the course of human history.”

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The pedagogy alternates contemplative, memory-based approaches in the grammar stage with Socratic dialogue/seminar in upper grades; there is explicit mention of Socratic method, seminars, and rhetoric training in upper school.

- Lower School memory/chants and “Scholé”-like restful moments are described, balancing active inquiry with contemplative practice.
- There is direct mention of a “Socratic method” used in instruction and of upper-school rhetoric/thesis work.
- The pedagogy aligns with classical ideals (memory work in grammar stage; dialectic/seminar in logic/rhetoric; public speaking in rhetoric; contemplative moments).
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic; seminar; dialectic; recitation; chanting; memory work; scholé; rhetoric; debate; public speaking.
 - Negative keywords present: project-based learning-focused or constructivist emphasis is not present in public materials; there is no explicit “experiential learning only” framing.
 - Frequency: 6–8 strong positives; 0–1 potential negative signals (not evident in public content).
 - Why this rating: The combination of Socratic inquiry in upper grades and chant/memory-based pedagogy in the lower grades matches classical pedagogy expectations. CLASSICAL.
- Citations and textual anchors
 - Socratic/dialectic in upper school, rhetoric training: “The literature curriculum focuses on close reading, Socratic discussions, and essay writing” and related upper-school pedagogy.
 - Lower-school memorization/chanting and wonder: “grammar-stage ... chanting ... sense of wonder” described in grammar-stage narrative.
 - Explicit Socratic method in classroom practice: “Socratic method to sharpen students’ reasoning.”

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Multiple references to faculty leadership and the school’s core through Head of School, faculty pages, and the idea that teachers are living exemplars and mentors. Public materials emphasize virtuous teacher leadership and the living-curriculum concept.
 - The Head of School and faculty profiles describe leaders with deep disciplinary and biblical/theological grounding; the content emphasizes teachers as “the living curriculum” and as virtuous exemplars.
 - The site presents a profile of leadership (Head of School) and faculty structure with a culture of mentorship and collaboration.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as core; collegial culture; mentorship; virtue; formation.
 - Negative keywords present: “facilitators/guides on the side” (negative term) is listed in the classical lexicon as a potential signal, but public content does not use this framing; rather, it emphasizes teacher leadership and exemplar status.
 - Frequency: 4–6 positive indicators; 0 negative signals in public content.
 - Why this rating: The public materials consistently frame faculty as virtuous, knowledgeable, and central to the school’s curriculum and culture. CLASSICAL.
- Citations and textual anchors
 - Head of School profile and leadership language: “Head of School” and leadership statements.
 - Portrait of a Teacher and the living-curriculum framing: explicit pages exist for faculty/teacher portraits and the living-curriculum concept.
 - Faculty as central and collaborative language appears in multiple faculty-related pages.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Strong, explicit emphasis on parent partnership; parents as co-teachers; opportunities for parent formation and involvement (book groups, lectures, campus events). The site describes Parent Partnership language and open-campus policy in multiple places.
 - The public materials advertise and describe parent engagement channels (tours/open houses, parent groups, etc.). This aligns with the classical emphasis on family formation and home-school partnership.

- The school’s materials describe a mission that includes parent involvement as a primary influence, not mere consumer engagement.
- Positive Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; home-centered education; parent involvement; parent partnership; open campus; family liturgy; home-school collaboration.
 - Negative keywords present: consumer language or customer-model signals are not evident in the public content; the site emphasizes partnership rather than consumption.
 - Frequency: 5–7 positive indicators; 0–1 negative signals (none clearly evident in public content).
 - Why this rating: The site’s Parent Partnership and family-formation language align strongly with classical expectations for community engagement. CLASSICAL.
- Citations and textual anchors
 - Parent Partnership and formation: “The Academy Partner with Families” and “Parent Partnership.”
 - Family formation and home-life emphasis: “Parents are the primary influence... home influences” (Charlotte Mason influence page).
 - Open-campus/parent involvement: parent resources and events information on the Parents area.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose & Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

General assessment: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Not applicable here since the aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL (the rubric’s needle-moving section is reserved for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases).

ABSTRACT

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Core six-element summary:
 - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: Christian orientation with Nicene Creed; truth/goodness/beauty framed as transcendent ideals; sense of wonder around creation and education. Positive signals dominate with Creed-based and the triad emphasis.
 - Purpose & Goal: Formation of virtue and wisdom; liberal-arts telos; education as formation rather than merely information; emphasis on the true/good/beautiful as real. Positive signals dominate.
 - Curriculum: Trivium-based curriculum; grammar/logic/rhetoric; emphasis on Great Works and Western civilization; memory/chanting in early grades; strong upper-school Socratic/literary work; Latin study. Positive signals dominate.
 - Pedagogy: Mixed contemplative/restful and Socratic/dialectical approaches; grammar-stage chant/memory; upper-school seminars; rhetoric; public speaking; memory work integrated into pedagogy. Positive signals dominate.
 - Faculty: Model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; portrait-of-a-teacher concepts; leadership from the Head of School; collaborative culture. Positive signals dominate.
 - Parents & Community: Partner with families; parent formation; home-school alignment; open visits; community engagement. Positive signals dominate.
- Overall interpretation: The school adheres closely to the Six Essential Elements framework for classical education (as reflected in the Six Essential Elements corpus in the knowledge-base). The presence of Trivium-based curriculum, Great-Books orientation, formation-focused goals, strong faculty leadership, and robust parent/community partnership supports a CLASSICAL designation across all six categories.

Note on sources and keyword grounding - The evaluation above draws on the Jackson Hole Classical Academy crawl (public site material) to identify explicit curricular, pedagogical, and community themes (grammar/logic/reasoning, Socratic seminars, Great Works, Charlotte Mason influence, Creed-based formation, parent partnership, etc.). See campus and program pages and leadership/faculty content. Examples include Philosophy of Education; Curriculum and Academic Program pages; and Head of School/faculty materials.

- It also incorporates the Classical Education knowledge-base lexicon and Six Essential Elements corpus to map keywords (positive/negative indicators) onto each category, with explicit citations to the Six Elements lexicon and associated positive/negative keyword lists. Positive/negative keyword indicators are mapped to the school's public materials to justify the CLASSICAL designation. See the Six Essential Elements lexicon and positive keywords (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; formation; Trivium; Great Books; Socratic method; living curriculum; partnership with families).

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Creedal framing; Christian orientation; truth/goodness/beauty triad; the Creator-order narrative.
 - Keyword analysis: Positive indicators (truth, goodness, beauty; creed; wonder) outweigh any negatives (0). CLASSICAL.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Formation of virtue and wisdom; liberal-arts telos; education as formation.
 - Keyword analysis: Positive indicators (formation; virtue; wisdom; liberal education) dominate; negative signals absent. CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Trivium-based structure; grammar/logic/rhetoric progression; Great Works; memorization and chant; Latin; Western civilization.
 - Keyword analysis: Strong positive signals; minimal or no negative signals present. CLASSICAL.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Mixed contemplative and Socratic pedagogy; upper-school seminars; rhetoric and public speaking; memory-based methods in lower grades.
 - Keyword analysis: Positive indicators dominate; negative signals not evident. CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Head of School leadership; living curriculum; portrait-of-a-teacher/mentor language; collaborative culture.
 - Keyword analysis: Positive indicators dominate; negative signals absent. CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Partner with families; parent formation; open campus; parent involvement.
 - Keyword analysis: Positive indicators dominate; negative signals absent. CLASSICAL.

Overall: CLASSICAL

If you want, I can provide a sentence-by-sentence appendix mapping every category's evidence to the corresponding Positive/Negative keyword lists from the Six Essential Elements corpus and quote-identify each term with precise in-text citations.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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